
Staging Review

Changes for Sameer

Anna Lou Wellness

staging.annalouwellness.com

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Hi Sameer,

I went through the staging site in detail with Hettal yesterday morning. Below is a consolidated list of changes, each paired with the screenshot showing exactly what I am referring to. The red marks on the images are mine. Please work through these in order.

A few quick wins to keep in mind across everything:

- No em dashes or en dashes anywhere in body copy (commas, full stops, parentheses, or restructure the sentence instead).
- No clinical or SEO language in visible body copy. Keep "nervous system regulation", "somatic", "trauma-informed" in page titles and meta descriptions only.
- Brand language for the inner-work pages: inner world, signal system, signal scrambled, signal back online.

Thank you. Anything unclear, message me and I will clarify.

Anna

SECTION 1

Navigation

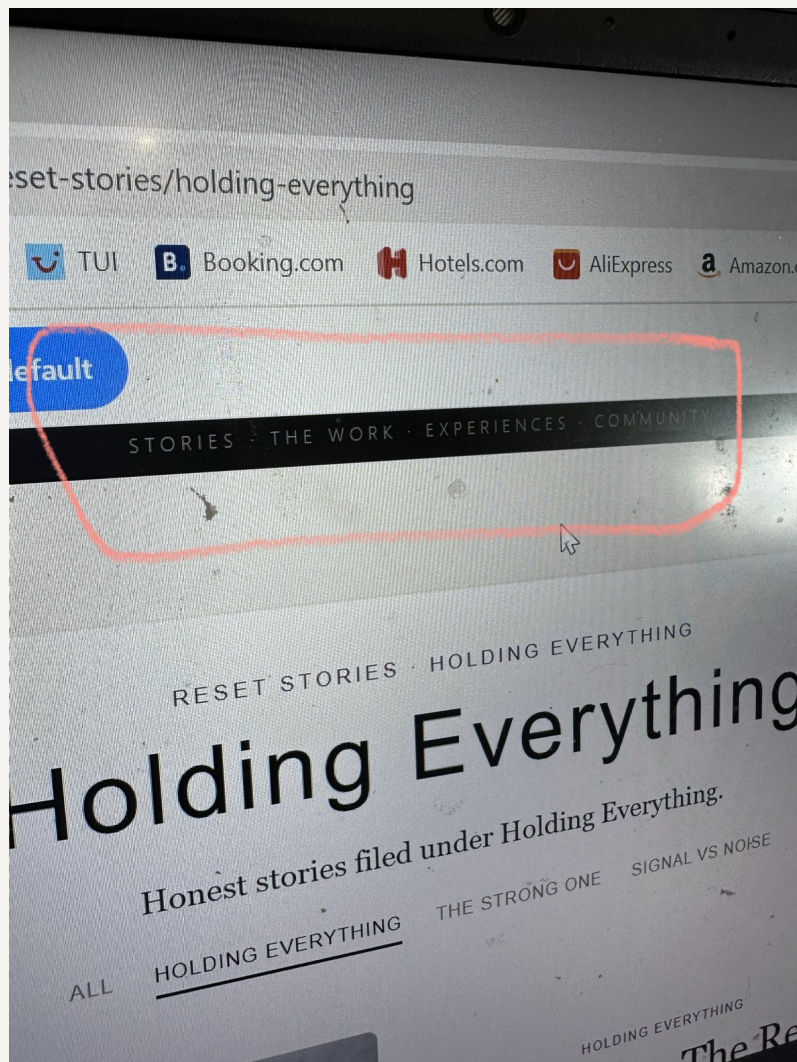
Changes to the main menu, mobile menu, and the labels users see at the top of the site.

1.1 Rename "The Work"

The label "The Work" does not make sense to a visitor landing cold. It does not communicate that this is the coaching section.

I want this changed to something clearer. Options I am considering: My Work, Work with Anna, or Coaching. I will confirm the final label once we have spoken, but for now please use Work with Anna as the placeholder so the meaning is unambiguous everywhere it appears.

This change needs to flow through both the top navigation bar (image below) and the dropdown / section heading on the deeper pages.



Top navigation bar showing "THE WORK" label, on the /reset-stories/holding-everything page.

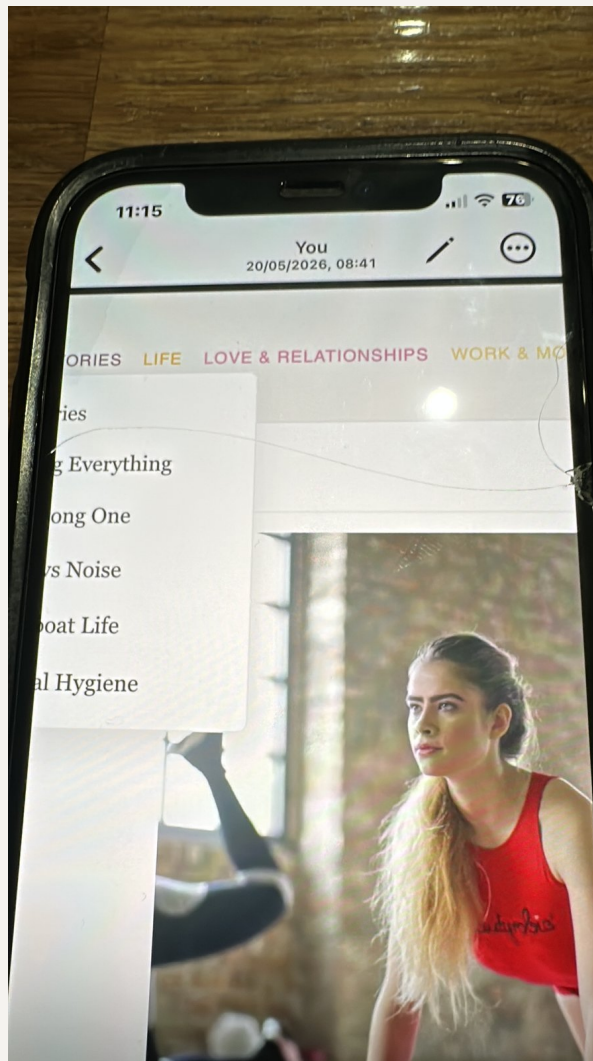
Action: Replace every instance of "The Work" with "Work with Anna" (placeholder, to be confirmed). Includes top nav, dropdown menu, breadcrumbs, page headings, and URL slug if possible.

1.2 Mobile menu items too cramped

On mobile the menu items (LIFE, LOVE & RELATIONSHIPS, WORK & MONEY, etc) sit too close together with no breathing room. The text is also too small.

Two things to fix. First, increase the spacing between items so they have room to breathe. Second, increase the font size so the menu is comfortable to read on a phone.

If the items still do not fit on one row, use a two-row layout (Cup of Jo does this and it works well). Do not let them cut off at the edge of the screen.



Mobile view. Menu items LIFE, LOVE & RELATIONSHIPS, WORK & MO[NEY] are cramped and the last one is cut off.

Action: Increase mobile menu font size and spacing. Allow a second row if needed so nothing is cut off at the screen edge.

1.3 Add Shop back into the main navigation

I had removed Shop from the top menu because I did not want the site to feel like just another coaching website. Hettal made a strong case and I now agree: users expect to see Shop in the main nav. Without it they have to hunt for it, which costs us conversions.

Please add Shop back into the main horizontal navigation. Keep the existing colour coding (Shop = green #5DCAA5).

Important: this does not change the editorial-first approach inside the stories. We are still not putting inline product links in body copy (see 5.2 for the alternative approach).

Action: Add Shop back into the top navigation bar in its green colour (#5DCAA5), placed between Experiences and Community.

SECTION 2

Homepage

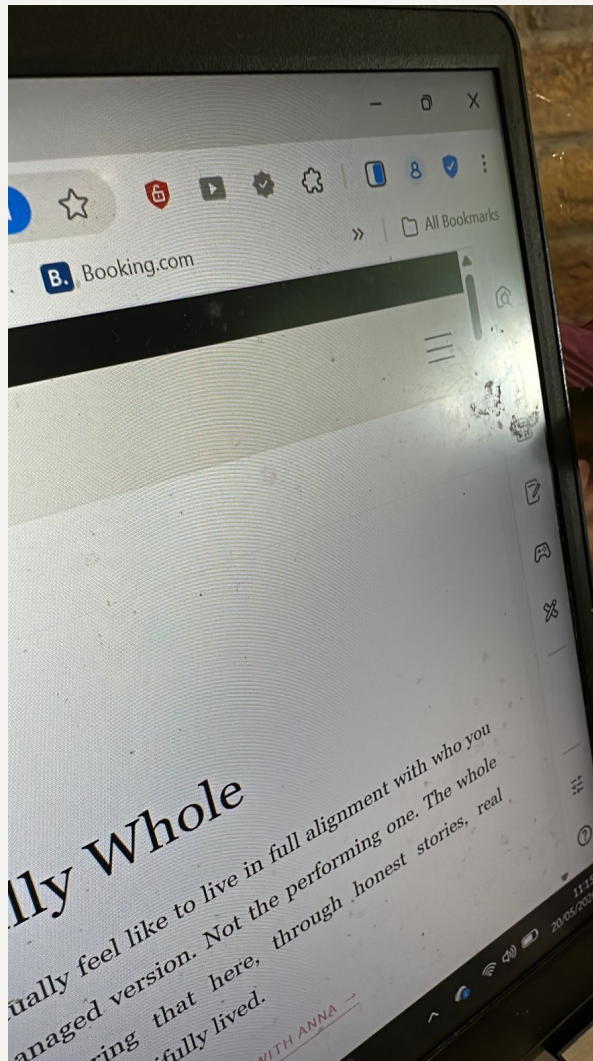
Spacing, colour, and the introduction block on staging.annalouwellness.com.

2.1 Large empty gap above "Beautifully Whole"

On desktop there is a very large empty area between the top navigation and the start of the "Beautifully Whole" introduction block. The photo on the left is small but the surrounding white space is huge, which makes the section feel unfinished.

Two ways to fix: either reduce the vertical spacing so the content sits closer to the navigation, or use a larger photo that fills the space properly. I prefer the second option, a more substantial photo on the left, but use your judgement.

Please check spacing across the rest of the homepage at the same time. Other sections have similar issues with small images surrounded by too much empty space.



Close-up of the desktop homepage showing the large empty area between the menu strip and the start of the "Beautifully Whole" copy.

Action: Reduce vertical spacing throughout the homepage. Either tighten the gaps or increase image sizes to fill the space. Audit the whole homepage at desktop width and report back.

2.2 Adjust the yellow background section on the homepage

The yellow background on the homepage feels off. It does not sit comfortably with the pink section next to it.

The work-and-money yellow at category level is fine. What I want changed is the homepage background yellow specifically. Try a lighter tone, or one of the pastel tints from the brand palette (cream #FFF0D2 or light gold #FFD07A as a soft wash).

Action: Swap the homepage yellow background tone for a softer, lighter version. Keep the work-and-money category yellow as it is.

SECTION 3

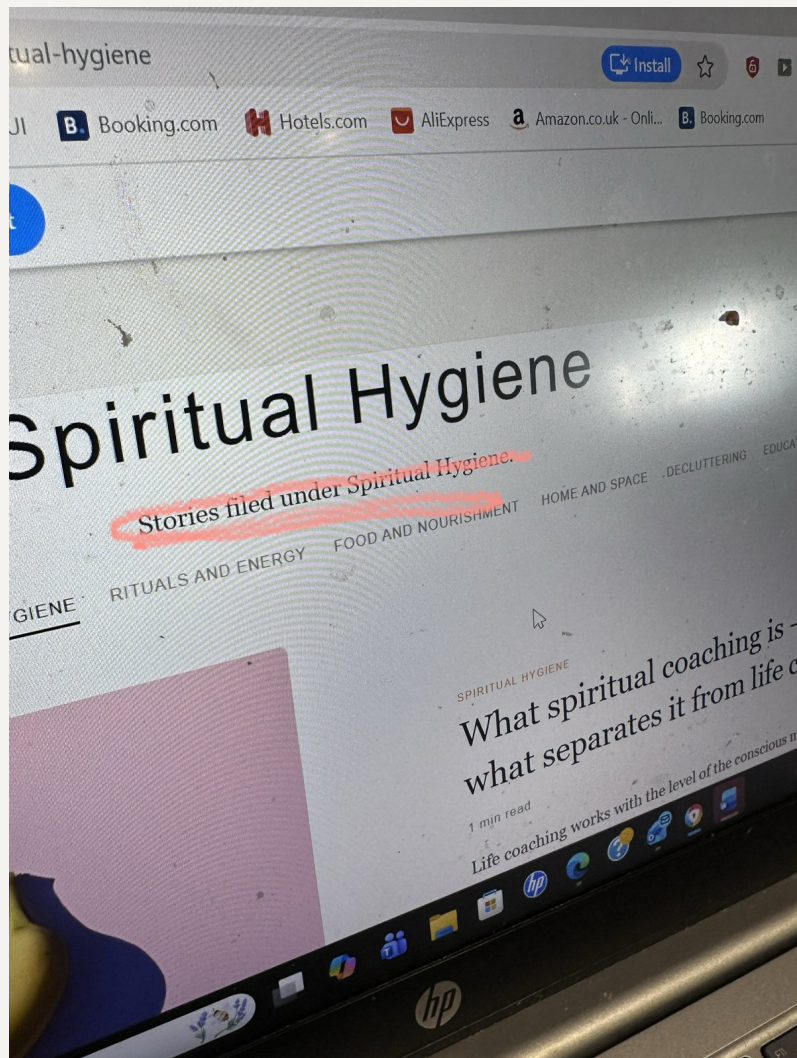
Section Pages

Cleanup that applies to every category landing page (Spiritual Hygiene shown here, but the same rules apply to Life, Love & Relationships, Work & Money, and all others).

3.1 Remove the "Stories filed under [topic]" subtitle

On every section landing page the subtitle reads "Stories filed under [topic name]" right under the topic name itself. It is repetitive and redundant. The reader already knows what page they are on.

Please remove this subtitle line across every section landing page. Spiritual Hygiene (below) is the example, but the same change is needed on Holding Everything, The Strong One, Signal vs Noise, Houseboat Life, and any other section page that uses this pattern.



Spiritual Hygiene page. The line "Stories filed under Spiritual Hygiene" sitting under the title is redundant and should be removed.

Action: Remove the "Stories filed under [topic]" subtitle from every section landing page on the site.

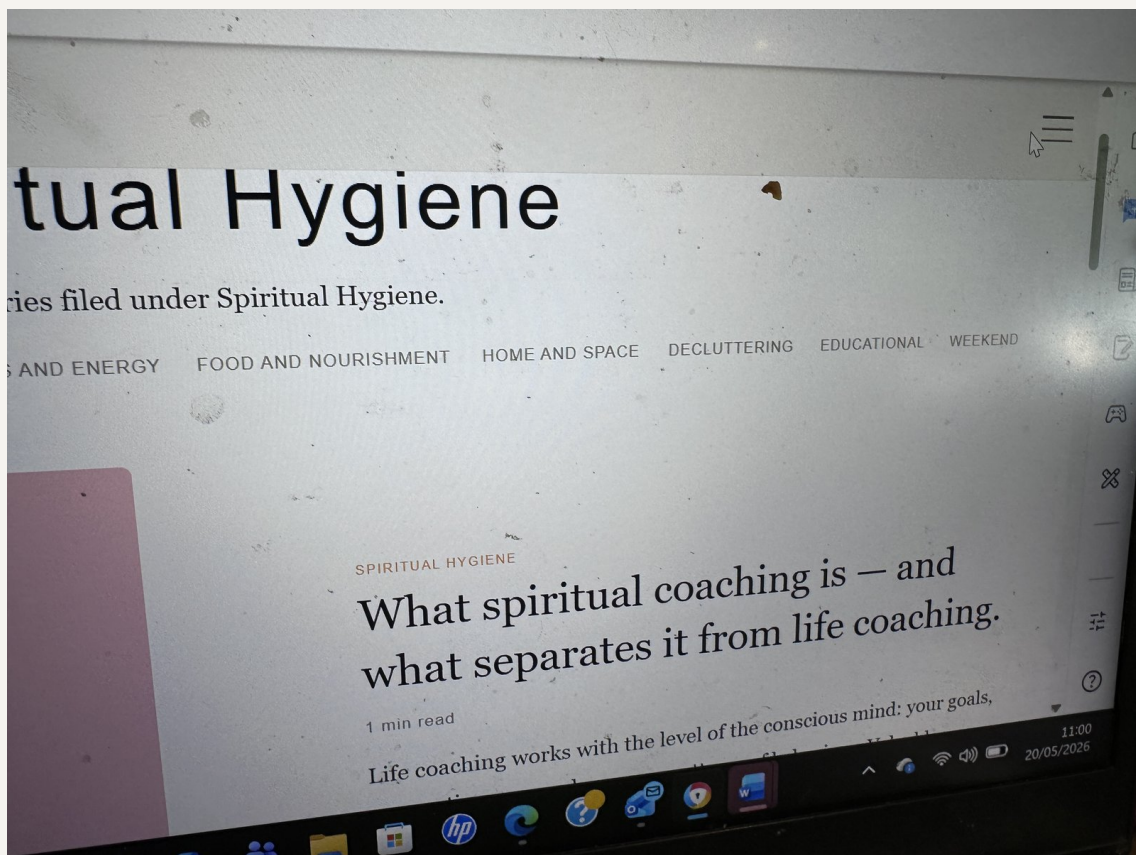
3.2 Declutter the subsections within each section

Inside Spiritual Hygiene we currently have: Rituals and Energy, Food and Nourishment, Home and Space, Decluttering, Educational, Weekend. That is too many. The user cannot absorb that much, and several of the labels do not make sense on their own (Weekend tells you nothing).

Keep: Rituals and Energy, Food and Nourishment, Home and Space, Decluttering, Style and Beauty.

Remove from this section: Educational (this is not what people come to Spiritual Hygiene for, and it can sit underneath one of the others), Weekend (label is unclear).

Aim for six sub-headings maximum across every section. We can always add more once we have audience data telling us what they actually want.



Spiritual Hygiene page subsections. Educational and Weekend need to come out.

Action: Reduce subsection labels in Spiritual Hygiene to: Rituals and Energy, Food and Nourishment, Home and Space, Decluttering, Style and Beauty. Apply the same audit across every other section (aim for six max).

SECTION 4

Reset Letters Holding Page

Currently live as a holding page for the 22 June 2026 launch. Needs simplifying.

4.1 Reduce the Reset Letters holding page to two colours

The current holding page for Reset Letters uses too many different colours and reads as confusing. The sensitive customer we are targeting will not get past it. The body text against the multi-colour treatment is hard to read.

I want it reduced to two colours, in the style of The Big Salad. Two colours can still feel rich and editorial. They become the visual theme of Reset Letters going forward.

My preferred pairings, in order: burgundy / plum with grey (masculine-feminine balance, works well), plum with light blue, or gold with green. Try the first one and send a screenshot.

The rest of the site colour palette stays as it is. This change is only for the Reset Letters holding page.

Action: Rebuild the Reset Letters holding page using two colours only. Start with burgundy/plum and grey. Send a preview before pushing live.

4.2 Fix the Substack link (currently linked to old account)

The sign-up button on the Reset Letters page is currently pointing to my old Substack URL. It needs to be repointed to the new Reset Letters publication.

Once the new Substack is live and the holding page is updated, please also add the canonical tag setup we discussed. The free Substack posts will be duplicated onto the website as Reset Stories so that we get the SEO benefit without Google penalising us for duplicate content. Each duplicated post needs the canonical tag pointing to the website version, not the Substack version.

Action: Repoint the Reset Letters sign-up to the new Substack publication. Confirm canonical tag setup is in place for any post duplicated between Substack and the website.

SECTION 5

Colour and Content Treatment

Specific colour calls, plus the rule on how products are linked from editorial content.

5.1 Reset Stories: text contrast on the image overlay

On the Reset Stories layout (the homepage and category feed), some of the text sitting over or near the photographs is not readable. The contrast is too low.

Either make the text white where it sits over a darker image, or shift the background block to give enough contrast.

Background colours overall are fine. They are subtle, not jarring. I do not want them more saturated. The fix is contrast on the text, not the colour of the background.

Action: Audit text contrast on Reset Stories cards (homepage and category feeds). Where contrast is poor, switch text to white or adjust the underlying block. Send a screenshot of the result.

5.2 Do not put product links inline in story copy

Inside any story (Reset Stories, Spiritual Hygiene articles, Lifestyle pieces), do not add shop links inside the body text. Reading a piece and being interrupted by "buy this necklace" links is annoying and breaks the editorial feel. Users will leave half-way through and we lose the conversion anyway.

The right way to link products is through photographs with hover tags. The reader hovers over a photo of me wearing a piece and sees a small tag that says "Anna is wearing the [piece name]" which links to the shop. This is the model many magazines use.

Use this sparingly. Not every photo needs a tag. Only the photos where the product is genuinely central to the story.

The body text itself can still mention a piece by name (for example, "I wore my moonstone necklace through every court hearing"). It just should not link out to the shop from within the sentence.

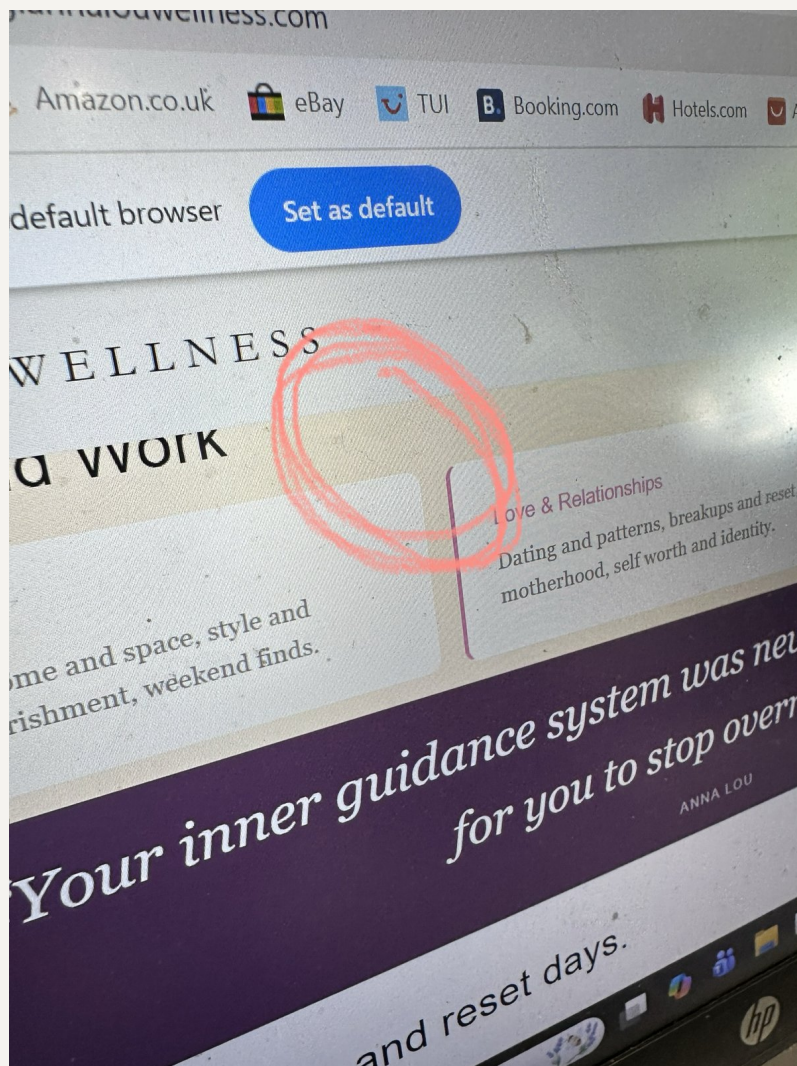
Action: Remove any inline product links from story body copy. Build a photo-hover-tag pattern for product references instead, used only on the photos where the product is central. Show me one example so I can sign it off.

5.3 Approved: the burgundy quote section

The full-bleed burgundy section with the "Your inner guidance system was never..." quote works really well. The tone, the contrast with the cream above, and the white italic typography all sit beautifully.

Please keep this exact treatment. The burgundy and grey pairing I mention in section 4.1 above is partly inspired by how good this block looks.

One small note: the WELLNESS wordmark above this section sits a little awkwardly against the warm cream band. Check the vertical spacing between the wordmark and the burgundy block so it does not feel squashed.



The WELLNESS wordmark and the burgundy quote section. Quote section approved. Check spacing between the wordmark and the band below it.

Action: Keep the burgundy quote section as-is. Check vertical spacing between the wordmark band and the burgundy band, and tighten if needed.

5.4 RESET LETTERS wordmark: new two-tone for the Substack

Aneeza is producing a new wordmark for Reset Letters, the Substack publication launching 22 June 2026. Two-tone treatment, matching the colour direction approved in 5.3.

- RESET in plum. Hex #5B2E55.
- LETTERS in blue. Hex #7BAFD9.

I want you to see what this looks like so the website can use the correct branding wherever Reset Letters appears, in particular on the holding page (4.1) and on any footer link to the Substack.

The wordmark exists in two layouts. Use the horizontal version for in-page placements and the stacked version where the space is square or vertical. Aneeza will send you the final asset files once they are signed off.

When the assets arrive, use them as-is. Do not change the typeface, colour, weight, or proportions.



Reset Letters wordmark, horizontal and stacked. RESET in plum #5B2E55, LETTERS in blue #7BAFDD.

Action: Wait for the final Reset Letters wordmark files from Aneeza. Once received, place them on the Reset Letters holding page (4.1) and use them anywhere on the site that references the Substack (footer link, sign-up modules, share cards).

SECTION 6

Logo, Footer, and Integrations

Final decisions on the wordmark, social icons, and integration tidy-up.

6.1 Logo: stacked two-line wordmark (ANNA LOU / WELLNESS)

Update on the earlier decision. The site logo is now a stacked two-line wordmark, not the single horizontal line we had previously locked.

- ANNA LOU on the top line.
- WELLNESS on the line underneath.

All caps. Serif typeface (Garamond, in line with the brand). Both lines centred. Brand black (#231F20) on the header background.

Four direction options are shown below for the proportions and hierarchy. I will confirm which variant to use after I have lived with them for a day. For now, please assume Variant C (equal size, WELLNESS letter-spaced wider) as the working default so layout work can continue.

This change replaces the earlier "single horizontal line" decision documented in previous notes. The wordmark stays text-based (no crown, no artwork file).

ANNA LOU
WELLNESS

Variant A: equal size, equal tracking

ANNA LOU
WELLNESS

Variant B: name larger, descriptor smaller with wider tracking

ANNA LOU
WELLNESS

Variant C: equal size, WELLNESS tracked wider

ANNA LOU
WELLNESS

Variant D: bold name, regular descriptor

Four direction options for the stacked header logo. Working default: Variant C. Final variant to be confirmed.

Action: Switch the site header from the single-line "ANNA LOU WELLNESS" to the stacked two-line version. Use Variant C (equal size, WELLNESS wider tracked) as the working default. I will confirm the final variant separately.

6.2 Add social media icons to the footer

Currently I cannot see the social media links in the footer. They need to be there.

Add icons for: Instagram, LinkedIn, Substack, YouTube, Podcast. I will send the URLs separately. Keep them in the footer only, not in the top navigation.

I am holding the YouTube embed codes until I have recorded enough content, but the footer icon link should go live now and point to the channel page (even if the channel is empty for the moment).

Action: Add Instagram, LinkedIn, Substack, YouTube, and Podcast icons to the footer. I will send the destination URLs in a separate message.

6.3 Press / "As Seen In" placement is approved

The press strip at the bottom of the homepage is in the right place. Leave it there.

Two outstanding items on this strip though, both flagged before:

- Press logos still need to be the licensed logo artwork for each title, not the brand names typed out.
- Certifications (ICF, CPD, TRE) need to be proper badge artwork, not typed text.

I will send you the artwork files for both press logos and certifications by the end of this week.

Action: Hold this until I send you the press logo and certification badge artwork. Then swap the typed names for the real artwork.

SECTION 7

Summary Checklist

Quick reference list of every change in this document, in priority order.

#	Change
1.1	Rename "The Work" to "Work with Anna" everywhere
1.2	Increase mobile menu font size and spacing; allow two rows
1.3	Add Shop back into main navigation (green #5DCAA5)
2.1	Reduce vertical spacing on homepage; audit all gaps
2.2	Replace homepage yellow background with a softer tone
3.1	Remove "Stories filed under [topic]" subtitle on all section pages
3.2	Trim Spiritual Hygiene subsections; aim for six max site-wide
4.1	Rebuild Reset Letters holding page in two colours (start with burgundy + grey)
4.2	Repoint Reset Letters sign-up to new Substack; confirm canonical tag setup
5.1	Fix text contrast on Reset Stories cards
5.2	Remove inline product links from stories; build photo-hover-tag pattern
5.3	Keep burgundy quote section; check spacing above it
5.4	RESET LETTERS wordmark: place on the holding page and Substack links once Aneez delivers files
6.1	Logo: switch to stacked two-line wordmark — ANNA LOU above WELLNESS (Variant C default)
6.2	Add Instagram, LinkedIn, Substack, YouTube, Podcast icons to footer
6.3	Swap typed press names and certifications for proper logo / badge artwork (waiting on me)

Items waiting on me: 6.3 (press artwork and certification badges). I will get those over to you this week.

Everything else: please proceed. Message me on anything unclear.

Thanks,

Anna